

Leather Terror – Visual Listening Notes

Portfolio Excerpt by B. M. Spangler

These notes are part of an ongoing exegesis of Carpenter Brut's album *Leather Terror*. Instead of treating each track as audio only, I use them as engines for visual and narrative simulation. The pairs below – Day Stalker / Night Prowler and Paradisi Gloria / Leather Terror – function as single, long-form movements in my head, driving a continuous combat and coronation sequence.

Day Stalker / Night Prowler – Rogue Cutscene

I do not hear Day Stalker and Night Prowler as two separate songs. I experience them as a single, continuous rogue fight. The music becomes a combat engine clocking a Mythic+ or raid pull in World of Warcraft. At the first major drop in Day Stalker, the rotation ramps up: crowd control begins to layer in, and the rogue starts chaining shadowsteps, Feint, and Crimson Tempest in a flowing weave that controls the entire field.

The emphasis for me is not on damage meters, but on the visual logic of the fight. The rogue is a field conductor with blades, moving quickly but precisely through a dense pack of enemies. Area damage and damage-over-time effects mark the space, while interrupts and stuns keep the encounter on my terms. The soundtrack's dynamics map directly to escalation in the encounter: as the track intensifies, the number of simultaneous decisions the rogue must make increases.

By the time Night Prowler reaches its own peak, a major cooldown has come back online and the rogue undergoes a semi-mythic transformation. In my internal cutscene this is the moment legendary daggers flare to life and the fight turns into an onslaught of Envenom and area finishers, punctuated by kicks, kidney shots, blinds, and vanish–re-engage chains. Even in the quieter prowl sections between peaks, the fight never truly stops: the rogue is circling, repositioning, and lining up the next brutal sequence. The pair functions as a single visualization of a high-skill rogue operating at the edge of possibility – almost limitless in options, but still constrained by the real rules of the game.

Paradisi Gloria / Leather Terror – Coronation in the Dark

Paradisi Gloria and Leather Terror form a second unified movement for me: a coronation sequence staged on a battlefield. The opening of Paradisi Gloria is low energy but tense. I picture myself encircled by adversaries whose real aim is not simply to injure me, but to pull me away from where I belong and strip me of authorship over my work. When the first surge

in the track hits, I slip into the rogue persona and begin a focused single-target duel. The logic is simple: if I drop this one opponent cleanly in front of the rest, they will bend the knee.

A brief lull in the music becomes the first reset after that opening onslaught, before the combat scales up again. As the piece builds, the camera in my mind pulls back to reveal a full war tableau: riders and armored lines charging downhill, one-on-one combat repeating across the field while thousands watch. When Paradisi Gloria reaches its close, the field is littered with the dead. In a wide-frame shot there is one figure left standing among fallen comrades and enemies alike. That figure is me.

Leather Terror is the identity snap that follows. I am no longer just one fighter surviving the chaos; I recognize myself as the title character of the story. The track marks a transformation into a home-field monster: the battlefield is no longer an environment I was merely thrown into, but terrain I claim as my own. I fight multiple adversaries at once, landing heavy, decisive blows while taking little meaningful damage. The important point is not gratuitous violence but asymmetry of familiarity. I am used to this darkness. The shadowed battlefield, with all its confusion and threat, has become my native environment.

In that sense, the pair functions as a warning. To campaign against this figure is to enter a battleground he has already mapped in detail. Paradisi Gloria supplies the encirclement and the first duel; Leather Terror supplies the coronation in the dark, where the protagonist stops being a passive survivor and fully inhabits the role of authored terror on his own ground.

Both movements show how I use music as a Current Mood Setting Device: not just to feel something, but to run detailed, rule-consistent simulations in my head. The album becomes a way to explore agency, authorship, and asymmetric advantage under pressure, using combat and coronation as visual languages.